



Spectacled bear

Tremarctos ornatus

South America's only bear is also one of its largest land mammals. Just 2–3 ft (60–90 cm) high at the shoulder, they make their homes in a variety of Andean habitats, ranging from cloud forests to high-level grasslands bordering rainforests. Spectacled bears spend much of their time in trees, where they build a platform of sticks to sleep on and forage from. They eat fruit, flowers, and succulent plants. They also sometimes hunt insects, birds, and small rodents.

The bears are solitary except during the mating season, from April to June, when a male and female stay together for up to two weeks. Cubs are born from December to February. Males do not play any part in raising the young, and may even kill cubs. While pumas and jaguars prey upon the cubs, the greatest threat to the species comes from habitat loss and hunting by humans.

► DISTINCTIVE MARKINGS

The spectacled bear gets its name from the cream or yellow markings around its eyes. These markings often extend down to its chest.

creamy white markings

- ↔ 4–6 ft (1.3–1.9 m)
- ⚖ 132–390 lb (60–175 kg)
- ⊗ Vulnerable
- 🌿 Fruit, succulent plants, birds



W. South America

